

Suchika Tariyal creates history; wins bronze in MMA at Asian Games

Suchika Tariyal settled for a bronze medal in the women's traditional 60kg mixed martial arts event of the Asian Games here on Monday as Singapore's Hui Hoon Teo was awarded the semifinal win on account of her lesser weight after the two fighters drew the gruelling bout. This was India's maiden medal in the discipline that made its debut at the 20th edition of the Games. Tariyal, however, was shattered by the result and wept bitterly on the mat once the final decision was announced in Teo's favour. The 36-year-old from Haryana took up combat sports after facing street harassment as a 12-year-old and went on to become a multi-discipline combat sport athlete, representing India in judo at the 2022 Commonwealth Games and in kurash at the 2023 Asian Games.

Meanwhile, India's shooters added three more medals, winning silver in the men's 10m air rifle team event before Himanshu Dhillon and former world champion Rudranksh Patil secured silver and bronze, respectively, in the individual final. Dhillon scored 252.4 points to finish behind China's Lihao Sheng (254.2), while Rudranksh took bronze with 230.9. The feat comes a day after the women's 10m air rifle shooters also clinched two silver medals.

PTI/THE HINDU

FULL REPORT ON PAGE 6

India-New Zealand free trade pact ratified

India and New Zealand on Monday formally ratified the Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between the two countries, New Zealand's Trade and Investment Minister Todd McClay said. The pact will come into force on October 20, 2026, he added.

The two countries had inked the FTA on April 27, 2026, which was termed by Prime Ministers of both countries as a "historic" step towards deepening trade, investment, and people-to-people ties. The agreement will see New Zealand removing all tariffs on all goods imported from India, while India will remove or reduce tariffs on 95% of current imports from New Zealand.

On September 16, New Zealand's Parliament passed legislation to implement the FTA. In pursuance of the ratification, India and New Zealand formally exchanged Diplomatic Notes confirming the completion of respective domestic legal processes for the FTA.

PTI

Putin's party set to retain power in Russia

MOSCOW, RUSSIA: Vladimir Putin's ruling United Russia party won a large majority in the country's parliamentary elections, marked by cyberattacks and a barrage of Ukrainian drone strikes, according to results published by state media early Monday.

The election, held to elect members in all seats of the lower house State Duma, is the first since Moscow launched its large-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022. No party opposed to the war was allowed to run, with Russia's Supreme Court removing the anti-war Yabloko party off the ballot weeks before the vote. Voting also took place in Ukrainian territories occupied and annexed by Russia.

According to results reported by Russian news agencies after just over 71% of ballots were counted, United Russia took 57.5% of the vote. The Communist Party and LDPR nationalists trailed behind. AFP



Have you been following the news headlines?

- 1 What is the first wild cat discovered recently, after over a century, called?
- 2 Name the branch of medicine that studies and treats problems affecting the skin.
- 3 Name the American scientist who led the development of Fortran.
- 4 ICC is eyeing which country in a bid to expand cricket?
- 5 Which is the largest port in India by cargo volume?

Answers on page 3

What is big data?

TECH TALK

Data has been around forever — the ancient Romans kept census records, homemakers keep a recipe box, your phone keeps a photo history. That's all data, and it's nothing new. But, big data is different.

The definition

What is big data? It's what happens when there's so much data, arriving so fast, in so many different formats, that your normal tools break trying to handle it. Think less "shoebox of receipts" and more "every receipt ever printed, arriving every second, forever."

Computer scientists actually built a handy little framework for what makes data officially "big," known as the 3 Vs. There's volume — Google processes billions of searches a day. There's velocity, meaning how fast it shows up — thousands of tweets posted per second.

And there's variety, meaning how many different shapes the data takes, from text and video to GPS pings. Years later, people added a fourth V, veracity, because it turns out a lot of data is simply wrong, and figuring out what to trust has become half the battle.

Okay, but who decided to call it "big data"? The phrase started floating around research circles in the 1990s, and some credit engineers at Silicon Graphics who needed a name for datasets too chunky for their computers to process. But the term really caught fire in the early 2000s, once the internet and mobile phones started producing more information than anyone had a plan for.

What's the problem?

Big data is mostly made of information about people — what you buy, where you go, who you talk to — and that creates real problems. Companies can build eerily accurate profiles of you without you ever knowingly agreeing to it. Governments can use the exact same tools for surveillance. Algorithms trained on biased historical data can end up repeating, or even amplifying, that bias in places like hiring, lending, or policing. And because big data takes serious infrastructure, a small number of companies that control the most data end up holding an outsized amount of economic and political power. PHOTO: UNSPLASH



So much data!

Why didn't this happen earlier? We've had computers since the 1960s. Two things had to line up first, and for decades, neither one existed. Storage had to get cheap. In the 1980s, saving a single gigabyte of data cost thousands of dollars, so nobody was hoarding information "just in case." By the 2010s, storage cost pennies, and it suddenly made economic sense to save everything instead of deleting it.

On top of that, someone had to invent tools that could actually process this much mess. Traditional databases choked on data this large and disorganised. Around 2004 to 2006, engineers at Google and Yahoo built new systems — most famously a framework called Hadoop — that could split a giant task across thousands of ordinary computers working as a team, instead of needing one impossibly powerful supercomputer. Pair that with advances in machine learning, and all that stored data went from being useless digital clutter to being genuinely valuable.

The rules

There is no single universal law that governs big data. The European Union's GDPR, which took effect in 2018, is the strictest and most widely copied privacy law in the world. Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, together with the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025, are the laws India has enacted to protect its citizens' data.

INDONESIA: RESCUERS SAVE ORANGUTANS FROM FIRE

BIG SAVE This handout image released by Indonesia's Ministry of Forestry shows a mother orangutan and her baby being evacuated by joint rescue team members after they were trapped by smoke from forest and land fires in a palm oil plantation area in Pelang village, Ketapang, West Kalimantan.

FIRE RESCUE The mother orangutan, estimated to be around 15 years old, and her one-to-two-month-old baby survived in a narrow 400-square-metre area surrounded by oil palm trees and partially scorched land.

INDONESIA has struggled for weeks to contain fires that have scorched large tracts of Borneo and Sumatra, with the smoke drifting across the region. Indonesia is one of the most biodiverse places on Earth. It has over 250 species of birds, gibbons, macaques, clouded leopards, and five species of cats. PHOTO: AFP



Over 180 scientists sign urgent appeal to tackle upcoming 'super' El Nino event

RAIN CHECK

More than 180 scientists and ecologists in India have signed an appeal to fellow researchers and field practitioners to prepare for an upcoming "super" El Nino event, which is likely to have devastating impacts on the country's natural systems. El Nino is marked by the unusual warming of surface waters in the tropical Pacific Ocean.

In the Pacific Ocean, temperatures have steadily risen above the 0.5 degrees Celsius threshold, reaching more than 2.6 degrees Celsius in August. Projections report possible

anomalies of more than 4 degrees Celsius, the highest in the past 1,000 years.

"We call upon fellow ecologists to respond by strengthening and expanding our research and monitoring efforts to better understand the effects of extreme climate events on the natural world and connected social systems," the signatories said in their appeal.

Earlier this month, the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) had said that the prevailing El Nino conditions were most likely to intensify into "a very strong event" in the coming months and persist through February 2027. An El Nino event of

such strength could have severe effects on India, its population and ecology.

These include widespread bleaching and mortality of coral, an increase in wildfires, and the death of large rainforest trees, according to the signatories. There is also a high probability of drought and extreme heat conditions, which could be catastrophic for India's farmers, fishermen and shepherds.

"In addition though, more subtle impacts on India's nature — including delayed fruit production or changes in animal behaviour — could be equally important, but may be much less visible unless you are specifically looking for

them," said the scientists and ecologists.

They urged fellow scientists to take advantage of the warning signs and mobilise as a community to document and study the impact of this event on India's nature. Roxy Mathew Koll, climate scientist with the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology and one of the signatories, said in a statement. "We must document these changes as they unfold, but also safeguard the ecosystems that remain and reduce the pressures already weakening them. What we learn and protect during this El Nino can help India prepare for a warmer and more volatile future." PTI



20-MINUTE ACTIVITY FOR CHILDREN - 1621

GK Corner (3 mins)



A kendo practitioner puts on a protective helmet, known as a men, ahead of a demonstration during Planet A Matsuri 2026 in Dakar, Senegal — a two-day festival celebrating anime, gaming, K-pop and Japanese culture. Kendo means “the way of the sword” in Japanese and developed from the sword-fighting techniques of the samurai. Practitioners use a flexible bamboo sword instead of a real blade. Can you guess what is this bamboo sword called? PHOTO: AFP

Ans:Shinai

Two-minute comprehension

Read the paragraphs below and answer the questions

Italian health authorities see evidence that rising temperatures and longer warm seasons are helping mosquitoes spread West Nile virus across a wider area, during more months of the year.

More than 650 infections have been reported in Italy so far this year, accounting for roughly half of all cases recorded in Europe, according to local health authorities.

“Higher temperatures linked to climate change help mosquitoes reproduce and extend the transmission season, increasing the chances that infected mosquitoes will spread the virus to people,” said Antonino Bella, researcher at Italy’s National Institute of Health, or ISS. West Nile has been considered endemic in Italy since 2020, when cases started to surge, and is now reported every summer and early fall. About 80% of infected people develop no symptoms, while most others experience a mild flu-like illness. Severe neurological complications occur in a small minority of cases, mainly among older adults and people with underlying health conditions. Experts say this year’s case numbers are broadly in line with recent seasons. But warmer temperatures favour mosquito reproduction and can mean the transmission season sometimes lasts as late as November, Bella explained. Areas once largely unaffected are increasingly reporting infections, reflecting a gradual expansion of the virus across the country. Italy’s experience with the virus is drawing attention from European countries located farther north.

- 1) What conditions are helping mosquitoes spread West Nile virus?

- 2) How many infections have been reported so far?

- 3) What are the symptoms of West Nile virus?

Unscramble - in a minute

Y	I	T	R	N	D	S	U

A noun, the word means the people, companies, and activities involved in the production of goods for sale, especially in factories.

Ans: Industry

AMAZING ANAGRAMS

The following sentences are incomplete. In each, the missing word/words is the anagram of the highlighted word/words. See if you can figure it out!

1. Arun’s mother seems to be the only one who _____ about the fact that his injury won’t allow him to compete in any more **races**.
2. Most of the news focused in the city of **Toledo** spoke about multiple stores being _____ by an unidentified group of thieves.
3. I keep telling you to come to my house in **the countryside**! I can guarantee that you will find ____ **city dust** ____!
4. She was threading a **rondelle** into the necklace in the jewellery-making class she had _____ in.

An **anagram** is a word or phrase that is formed by rearranging the letters of another.

Answer: 1. cares, 2. looted, 3. no, here, 4. enrolled

Word of the Day

- 2 minutes

ELEGIAC

Pronounced as: el-uh-JYE-ak
Meaning
relating to, or comprising an elegy,” an elegy being a sorrowful poem or song, and especially one that expresses sorrow for someone who has passed away.
Origin
Borrowed into English from Late Latin *elegiacus*, meaning “relating to elegies”, which is in turn derived from *elegiākos*, meaning “of or relating to an elegy”.
Usage
The poem for his father was very elegiac.
Activity
Now use the word in your own sentence.

Answer: In the *Diary of a Wimpy Kid*, Greg comes from a family of five.

WORD BUILDER

How many words can you make with the letters in the word

CONFIGURATION



MINI QUIZ 2 mins...

Today’s quiz is on chilli peppers

- 1) Which country is believed to be the birthplace of chilli peppers?
- 2) Which compound makes the chillies hot?
- 3) What scale is commonly used to measure the heat of chillies?
- 4) Who created the measure to identify the heat of chillies?
- 5) Chilli peppers belong to which plant family?

PHOTO: FREEPIK



Answers: 1) Mexico 2) Capsaicin 3) Scoville scale 4) Wilbur Scoville in 1912 5) Solanaceae

In how many minutes did you complete today’s activities?



Journal Writing

5 minutes

Dear Diary,

If I could talk to a bird, I would ask it...

Q W I K I P E D I A :
A DAILY SEARCH-AND-LEARN ACTIVITY

Ever been on Wikipedia to search for something? More often than not we start with one topic, click a few links and within no time, are eagerly reading something else. Qwikipedia is a game that tries to quench our curiosity to learn something new. Start with one search from a specific article in this newspaper, and get started on a journey of learning with multiple clicks. Surprise yourself by finding new routes each time!

THE TUESDAY’S TRAVELLER: ASIAN GAMES → TAP DANCE

ASIAN GAMES

Also known as Asiad, the Asian Games is a major multi-sport event held on the continent every four years, featuring athletes from all across Asia. It is organised and run by the Olympic Council of Asia. In the aftermath of World War II, Asia saw the formation of many sovereign states, and many countries sought to showcase their strength and skills without the use of violence. In 1948, the initial idea put forth by International Olympic Committee (IOC) representatives from China and the Philippines involved the revival of the Far Eastern Games, which was an event limited to East and Southeast Asian countries. However, it was Guru Dutt Sondhi, the Indian representative of the committee who proposed the idea of a single pan-Asian multi-sport event, which would come to be known as the Asian Games. This year, the games are mainly being held in Aichi Prefecture and Nagoya.



NAGOYA

Nagoya is the capital city of Aichi Prefecture in Japan, and the country's fourth-most populous city, with the population in 2025 recorded as 2.3 million. The city can be found in Central Japan, north of Ise Bay on the Nobi Plain. Following the Pacific War, the city's economy grew diversified, but the transport industry held great importance, holding railway connections to prominent cities like Tokyo and Kyoto. Some of the city's most popular landmarks include the Higashiyama Zoo and Botanical Gardens. The handicrafts that can be found in Nagoya include tie-dyed fabrics, and the making of straps for clogs called geta. Read on to learn more about clogs.



CLOGS

Clogs are defined as a type of footwear known for being sturdy with rigid soles. Traditionally, these soles are made of wood, though modern versions of this footwear tend to use alternative materials like polyurethane. Clogs were also seen as protective footwear for those who worked as farmers, miners, etc. The use of the footwear is not just limited to work, but can also be seen in various dance styles, known for the sound made when they hit the floor. Dances that were done with clogs also laid the foundation for many other styles like tap dance.

TAP DANCE

Tap dance is a popular form of dance that is mainly known for the sound dancers make when their tap shoes strike the floor. These strikes serve as a type of percussion for the performers, and the dance can be performed without the need for additional music. However, if there is music, one of the most popular genres that goes with tap dance is jazz. Tap began as a step-dance that combined the African-American and Irish dance styles. It was the fusion of African rhythms and European footwork that led to the eventual formation of this style of dancing. But while this emerged in the 17th Century, the dance's popularity did not rise until the mid-19th century.



So, the path we have travelled today is Asian Games → Nagoya → Clogs → Tap dance
Three clicks! Hop over! It's time for the next question.
Send in your paths for the above to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject: Qwikipedia

PHOTOS: THE HINDU, WIKIMEDIA COMMONS, AP

IN SCHOOL INBOX

Showcase your creativity

A couple of activity entries sent in by students.

ARTIVITY

Read the newspaper and create an original artwork based on a news item that interests you and send your entry in JPEG format (not as PDF) to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject - Artivity. ONLY artworks based on current news or issues relating to Science, Space, Environment, Wildlife and Sports will be considered for publication. Please AVOID mailing other works. Mention your name, class, school and city in the same mail (not in separate mails).



Name: Charumathi
Class: X
School: John Dewey Matric. Hr. Sec school, Panruti, Tamil Nadu



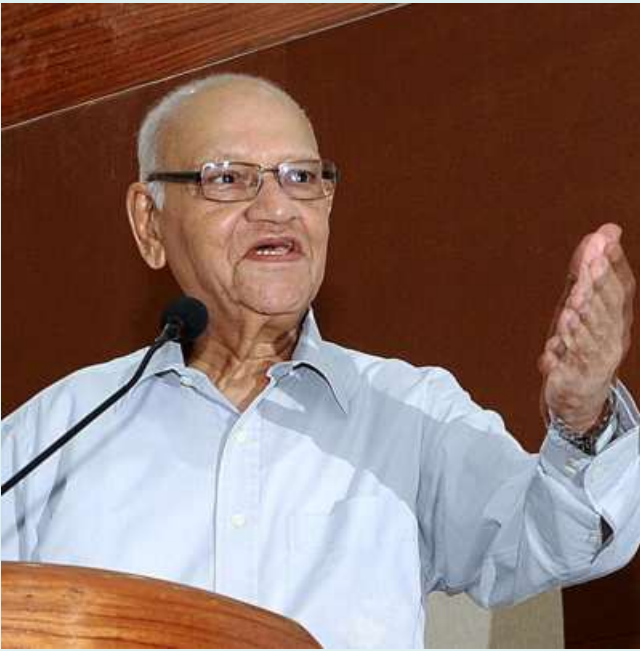
Name: K Supraja
Class: IX
School: Amaraaja Vidyalayam, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh

ROUND AND ROUND



People pose for a selfie in front of the "auruBOROS—Urban Memory and Collective" a public installation on the High Line in New York City, U.S. The artwork was conceived by the artist duo comprising of Marco Canavacci and Yena Young. It measures 30 × 10 × 10 metres and is made of golden mirrored TPU, with its form sustained entirely by air. PHOTO: REUTERS

GUESS WHO?



He is a retired Indian police officer, civil servant and statesman who notably led the Punjab Police during parts of the Punjab insurgency period. He joined the Indian Police Service (IPS) in 1953 and rose to be the Commissioner of Mumbai Police from 1982 to 1986. He also served as the Director General of Punjab Police. In 1987, he was awarded the Padma Bhushan, India's third-highest civilian award, for his services.

Answer: Jullio Ribeiro

SUDOKU

				2		4	8
1					5		2
		6	4		1	7	
	9		7		3		1
	8					5	
2		1			3		8
	7		2		8	6	
6		8					5
3	4		6				

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

A mind game and a puzzle that you solve with reasoning and logic. Fill in the grid with digits in such a manner that every row, every column and every 3x3 box accommodates the digits 1 to 9, without repeating any. The solution to today's puzzle is at right.

2	6	8	5	1	9	2	4	3
5	3	2	4	7	6	8	1	9
4	1	9	8	3	2	6	7	5
6	8	7	3	4	5	1	9	2
9	5	4	6	2	1	3	8	7
1	2	3	9	8	7	5	6	4
3	7	6	1	5	4	9	2	8
2	9	5	7	6	8	4	3	1
8	4	1	2	9	3	7	5	6



AT THE ASIAN GAMES

NAGOYA, JAPAN: Teenage shooter Himanshu Dhillon produced a superb performance in the back end to win silver, while former world champion Rudrankksh Patil clinched bronze as India secured two individual podium finishes in the men's 10m air rifle event at the Asian Games here on Monday.

The two individual medals came barely an hour after India had won silver in the men's 10m air rifle team event. Rudrankksh, Dhillon and Parth Mane combined for a team total of 1890.1 to finish second behind China. The three medals won by India on the second day of shooting have taken the country's tally in the sport to five. Indian shooters began their campaign with two silver medals in women's 10m air rifle on Sunday. India's overall medal tally at the continental showpiece has now shot to six, including the bronze won by Suchika Tariyal in the women's traditional 60kg mixed martial arts event.

The 20-year-old Dhillon shot 252.4 points to finish second behind China's Lihao Sheng, who won gold with 254.2. Rudrankksh, who had led the competition at stages, slipped to third with 230.9. Rudrankksh made a strong start and was involved in a tantalising battle with Lihao early in the final. He finished the second series with an aggregate of 106.0, with Lihao on 104.9 and Dhillon on 104.8.

However, Rudrankksh slipped in the sixth series of Stage 2, shooting a 9.7, while Dhillon produced a 10.6 to move ahead into second place to seal his second silver medal at the ongoing Asian Games.

PTI

Suchika Tariyal loses controversial MMA semifinal

She settles for bronze after a bitter match against Hui Hoon Teo

Suchika Tariyal settled for a bronze medal in the women's traditional 60kg mixed martial arts event of the Asian Games here on Monday as Singapore's Hui Hoon Teo was awarded the semifinal win on account of her lesser weight after the two fighters drew the gruelling bout.

This was India's maiden medal in the discipline that made its debut at the 20th edition of the Games. Tariyal, however, was shattered by the result and wept bitterly on the mat once the final decision was announced in Teo's favour. The bronze took India's overall medal tally to six at the continental showpiece. Shooters have bagged four silver medals and one bronze so far.

The closely-fought bout ended in a draw after regulation time, with Teo mounting an attack in the final few seconds. But Tariyal



Suchika Tariyal. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

managed to get her opponent down just as the buzzer went off. Teo had the better of the first period, but Tariyal fought back strongly in the second. With neither fighter able to establish a clear advantage, the

bout (a single, timed match or contest between two individual competitors) went into a one-minute extra round. Tariyal thought she had done enough to win, while Teo also celebrated at the final buzzer.

AT A GLANCE



Srihari qualifies for 50m backstroke final

TOKYO, JAPAN: Srihari Nataraj qualified for the 50m backstroke final at the Asian Games here on Monday, but the rest of the Indian swimmers endured a disappointing day, failing to make it beyond the heats. The two-time Olympian clocked 25.37 seconds, the same as Homer Abbasi of Iran, to finish third in his heat and joint-ninth overall to book his place in the final. Rishabh Das, who finished sixth in the men's 100m backstroke on Sunday, clocked 25.41 seconds to narrowly miss the final. He finished 11th overall and was the reserve.



Indian women's TT team sweeps aside Pakistan 3-0

TOYOTA, JAPAN: The Indian women's table tennis team swept aside Pakistan 3-0 in a one-sided tie to top Group F with three wins in a row and advance to the quarterfinals of the Asian Games here on Monday. At the Sky Hall here, India, who had defeated Indonesia and Singapore in their opening rubbers on Sunday, continued their dominant run against bitter rivals Pakistan. Sutirtha Mukherjee, who won a bronze medal in the women's doubles event at the last edition in Hangzhou, got India off to a flying start, beating Aleena Khan 11-3, 11-3, 11-4 in just 10 minutes. Sreeja Akula (in frame) sealed the tie.



Boxer Sumit Kundu moves into Asian Games pre-quarters

NISHIO, JAPAN: India's boxing campaign at the Asian Games got off to a fine start with Sumit Kundu clinching a unanimous decision win over Thailand's Bunjong Sinsiri in the 70kg opening round here on Monday. Kundu, one of the two Indian boxers who failed to medal at the Commonwealth Games last month, put on a dominant show in the last round to defeat Sinsiri 5-0 and move to the pre-quarterfinals. He will now take on Iraq's Ali Qasim Hamdan Al-Sarra. India have fielded an 11-member team, including six men and five women.



Deepika, Rutuja, Navneet power India to 17-1 win over Indonesia

KAKAMIGAHARA, JAPAN: The **troika** (trio) of destructive young forwards Deepika Sehrawat, Rutuja Dadaso Pisal and Navneet Kaur fired a hat-trick each as the Indian women's hockey team hammered Indonesia 17-1 to register its second consecutive Pool B win at the Asian Games. The 22-year-old Deepika (8th, 28th, 40th minutes), who scored eight goals in India's 19-0 drubbing of Uzbekistan in the lung-opener, converted three penalty corners, while Rutuja Dadaso Pisal (15th, 20th, 38th) found the net thrice from field play. Navneet's goals came in the 35th, 56th and 57th minutes.

PHOTOS: AFP, THE HINDU, PTI, SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Ferran Torres (right). PHOTO: AFP

Torres on target again as PSG beat Marseille

Ferran Torres opens with a bang, PSG win 2-1

PARIS, FRANCE: Ferran Torres continued the impressive start to his Paris Saint-Germain career by scoring the opener as the French and European champions won 2-1 at bitter rivals Marseille in Ligue 1 on Sunday.

Spain World Cup final hero Torres came off the bench to replace Khvicha Kvaratskhelia just before the hour mark and headed in a Desire Doue cross to give PSG the lead in the 66th minute at the Velodrome.

That brought the game to life, with England midfielder Angel Gomes scoring an excellent equaliser for Marseille on 72 minutes only for PSG captain Marquinhos to win the game for the visitors three minutes later. The Brazilian defender met a Nuno Mendes cross and had his initial effort saved by Marseille goalkeeper Jeffrey de Lange before bundling in the rebound.

United States star Timothy Weah, a former PSG player, was then sent off for a second booking as Marseille finished the game a man down.

Torres scored PSG's winning goal in Brest last weekend and now has seven goals in six appearances in all competitions since joining the reigning European champions from Barcelona. He

has only started three times.

"We knew that for us it was one of the most important matches of the season. We knew it wouldn't be easy but we managed to get the victory," Torres said at full-time, with PSG now up to sixth in the table, five points behind leaders Monaco after five fixtures.

"Now we can go away and play for our countries and disconnect from club football for a bit."

Torres, whose extra-time goal gave Spain victory over Argentina in the World Cup final in the United States in July, is in the squad as La Roja play their first game since that tournament away to England in the UEFA Nations League next weekend.

Struggling Marseille have now suffered four straight Ligue 1 defeats, and five losses in a row in all competitions. They therefore find themselves in the relegation zone as club football takes a three-week break. Monaco extended their unbeaten start to the campaign by beating Lens 2-1 on Friday, and the principality side are two points clear at the top of Ligue 1 from both Lyon and Paris FC.

Lyon hammered Rennes 4-0 on Saturday, while Paris FC won 2-1 against Strasbourg. AFP

Milan and Juventus end blips with home wins

Milan beat Lecce 3-0; Juve beat Atlanta 2-0

FLORENCE, ITALY: AC Milan and Juventus ended short Serie A slides on Sunday, as Fiorentina held Napoli and high-flying Como suffered a shock defeat to Frosinone.

Milan beat Lecce 3-0 at the San Siro to rise to fifth, two points behind early pace-setters Roma, Inter and Lazio.

Juventus returned to form with a 2-0 home win over Atalanta as Francisco Conceicao and Gleison Bremer struck either side of half-time.

The comfortable victory relieved pressure on Milan head coach Ruben Amorim after a three-match winless run in all competitions **had stalled** (slowed down, halted) his side's early progress.

"We still have a lot to do, but we are playing better and improving. The most important

thing, though, is that we are learning," said Amorim.

"In the last few games, we had some trouble because our positional structure was too rigid, whereas today the players had a bit more freedom and played better."

Christian Pulisic marked his first start of the season with his first Milan goal of 2026, making the breakthrough in the 14th minute with an exquisite finish.

He plucked a long pass out of the air with a **deft** (skilful and quick) first touch before finishing calmly.

Adrien Rabiot scored at the end of a flowing move after the break, before substitute Diego Moreira struck with his third goal in two league games.

Juventus had picked up one point in their previous two league



AC Milan's Christian Pulisic. PHOTO: AP

games but went in front in the 28th minute in Turin when Conceicao scored his first goal of the season with a low shot.

Chances fell at both ends in the second half as both goalkeepers were called into action and Juve striker Randal Kolo Muani made a goal-line clearance.

Bremer sealed the three points by guiding home a header from a corner with 13 minutes remaining as Juventus moved up to seventh and inflicted a third straight defeat on their former coach Maurizio Sarri.

Atalanta, who hired ex-Lazio, Chelsea and Napoli coach Sarri in the summer, sit 11th.

Earlier, Fiorentina maintained their unbeaten run under coach Paolo Vanoli with a 1-1 draw against Napoli. AFP

ARE YOU A SPORTS WIZ?

Test your knowledge with this weekly sports quiz!

This is Abhishek Sharma. He recently struck the fastest T20I century by an Indian. PHOTO: EMMANUEL YOGINI/ THE HINDU

- 1 Abhishek Sharma struck the fastest T20I century by an Indian. How many balls did he take to reach the century?
- 2 Playing the first European match in the club's history, Bournemouth won 2-1 in the UEFA Europa League against which team?
- 3 Arsenal completed an out-of-window transfer for an English 16-year-old striker. Name him.
- 4 Name the Indian trio who won silver for India at the 10m Air Rifle Women team event at the Asian Games.
- 5 In basketball, attempting to prevent a defender from guarding a teammate by standing in the defender's way is called _____.

Answers: 5 Screening and Vidarsa Vinod 4 Elavelli Valarivan, Sonam Maskar, 3 Vincent Joseph 2 Real Sociedad 1 30 balls